TutorLink

Find a verified tutor near you in under 5 minutes.

Zakariye Ali Mursal
PLP 2026

The Problem

Parents across East Africa spend weeks asking friends and WhatsApp groups to find a tutor they can trust.

- No way to verify a tutor's qualifications
- Prices are negotiated blindly, with no benchmark
- Most parents settle for "whoever a neighbor recommends"
- Tutors struggle to fill their schedules consistently

"I called six people before I found someone.
I still don't know if she's qualified."
— Parent, Nairobi

The Solution

TutorLink matches parents with background-checked, rated tutors in their neighborhood — bookable and payable in the app.

- Verified ID and qualifications
- Transparent hourly rate, set by the tutor
- Book, pay, and review in one place
- Tutors keep 85% of every session

Why Now

Three changes make this possible today:

1. Mobile money is mainstream — 70%+ of adults in the region use M-Pesa or similar; parents pay online easily

2. Remote learning normalized online services — post-2020, parents accept digital-first tutoring

3. Smartphone penetration crossed 60% — target users are already online

Five years ago, none of these were true.

Market Size

Bottom-up calculation:

- 500,000 secondary-school students in Nairobi County
- ~40% of families pay for tutoring → 200,000 families
- Average spend: KES 2,000 / month

TAM = KES 4.8B / year (~$37M)

SAM = KES 40M / month (5 target neighborhoods)

SOM (Year 1) = KES 1M / month (500 families)

How It Works

3 steps:

1. Parent enters subject, location, and budget
2. App shows 5 matched, verified tutors with ratings
3. Parent books and pays — tutor confirms — session happens

What we do better than anyone else: verification + speed.

Every tutor is ID-checked and reference-checked before

they can be booked.

Traction

Real progress so far:

- 52 parent interviews completed
- 20 tutors signed up and verified
- 3 paid pilot sessions delivered in the last month
- NPS from pilot parents: 9/10

Next milestone: 100 paid sessions in the next 60 days across 2 neighborhoods.

Business Model

Revenue:

- 15% commission on each tutoring session
- KES 500 / month tutor subscription for priority listing

Unit economics (per session):

- Average session: KES 800
- Our cut: KES 120
- Cost to serve: ~KES 30
- Gross margin: ~75%

Main costs: tutor verification, payment processing, marketing.

Competition

Competitor	Strength	Weakness
Facebook / WhatsApp groups	Free, familiar	No verification, no payments, no ratings
Traditional tutoring agencies	Trusted	Expensive (30–40% cut), slow
International platforms (Preply, etc.)	Good UX	Not local, no in-person, no M-Pesa

Where we fit: local trust + digital convenience + fair pricing for tutors.

The Team

Zakariye Ali Mursal — Founder, PLP 2026

- 3 years tutoring secondary students
- Built the first version of the app solo in 2 weeks
- Deep network of tutors and parents in target neighborhoods

Why me: I've lived this problem as a tutor and seen it as a student. I understand both sides of the marketplace.

The Ask

Raising: KES 3,000,000 (~$23,000) seed

Use of funds:

- 50% — 2 part-time engineers for 6 months
- 30% — marketing + tutor acquisition in 2 neighborhoods
- 20% — tutor verification and operations

Milestone it unlocks: 100 paid sessions / month within

6 months, proving the marketplace works before scaling.

Thank You

TutorLink

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📧 [zakariyeali351@gmail.com]

📱 [0793291380]

🔗 [https://www.linkedin.com/feed/foryou/]